

Session 11

Guiding principles and best practices for data capacity building

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Building data capacity

- Not everyone needs to be a data scientist.
- Data capacities in policymaking refer to how well infrastructure, systems, and people can use data effectively for decisions.
- Strengthening these abilities across different teams is essential.
- Complementary skill sets help value chain and improve over

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1. Identify gaps in data skills and statistical capacities

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Types of skills



Technical know-how

Mechanical, ICT, mathematical, scientific and/or other technology-related skills such as proficiency with a standard statistical package (e.g., R; Stata; SPSS) to carry out data processing, analysis and dissemination.



Work know-how

An employee's knowledge and understanding of work practices, processes, statistical concepts, definitions and classifications, business models, and organisational culture in use in the sector as well as about the relationships within organisations.



Problem-solving and creative thinking

The traits that support defining, approaching and analysing a problem in a technically correct manner and from a fresh perspective to devise new ways for

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Data Capability Framework



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Data Capability Framework - example

- **Capability:** Employ data coding and classification principles
- **Category:** Describe, Store, Use, and Save/Destroy

New

- Is aware of relevant data classifications and coding protocols, and their proper application to data in general.
- Knows who to consult for expert knowledge.

Proficient

- Has a comprehensive knowledge of data classifications and coding protocols.
- Knows where to seek expert advice and classification needed.

Expert

- Is consulted regularly by others about data classifications and coding protocols.

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Data Capability Framework Guide



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Link

Data Maturity Assessment Framework

Topic: Engaging with others

Topic: Having the right data skills and knowledge

Topic: Having the right systems

Topic: Knowing the data you have

Topic: Making decisions with data

Topic: Managing and using data ethically

Topic: Managing your data

Topic: Protecting your data

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Data Maturity Assessment Framework

- **Themes:** Uses, Data, Leadership, Culture, Tools, Skills
- **Maturity Levels:** Beginning, Emerging, Learning, Developing, Mastering

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Data Maturity Assessment Framework

- example

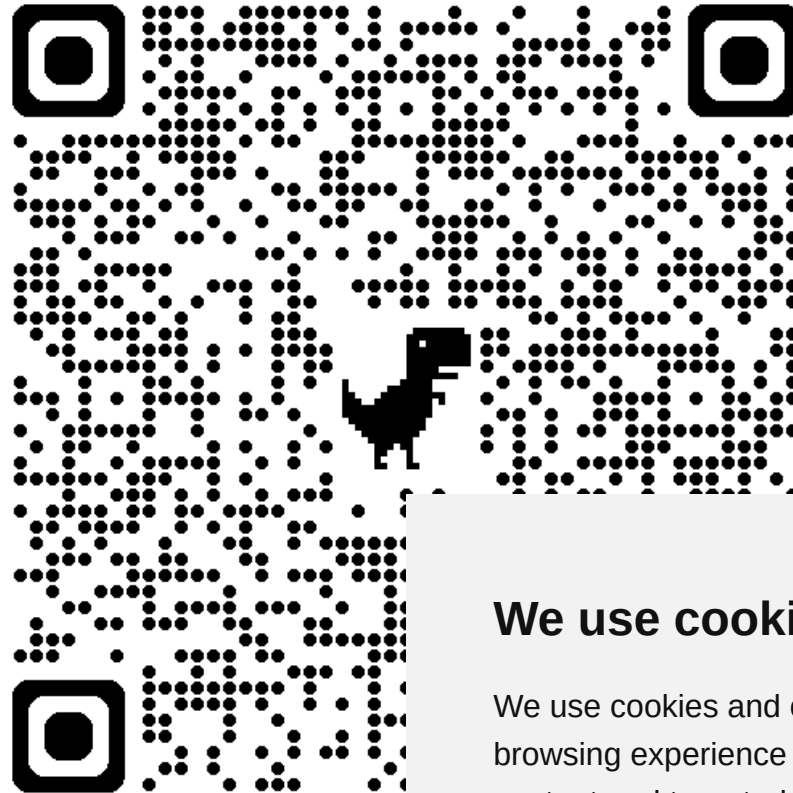
Topic: Engaging with others

ID	Row summary	Theme	Level 1: Beginning	Level 2: Emerging	Level 3: Learning	Level 4: Developing	Level 5: Mastering
1	Making data available to those who need it.	Culture	Makes data available by default only to a single specialist person or team. Discourages sharing data internally.	Beginning to share data internally either verbally or via reports. Does not encourage data sharing across teams or provide ways to share data directly.	Enables specialist users to access and share some data internally, but systems or processes limit access to and sharing of	Beginning to provide ways to access and share data directly, but non-expert staff may require some intervention from specialists to do	Data can be accessed and directly shared appropriately by all users who need it. All internal and external users can access data

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2. Build data capacities in your team

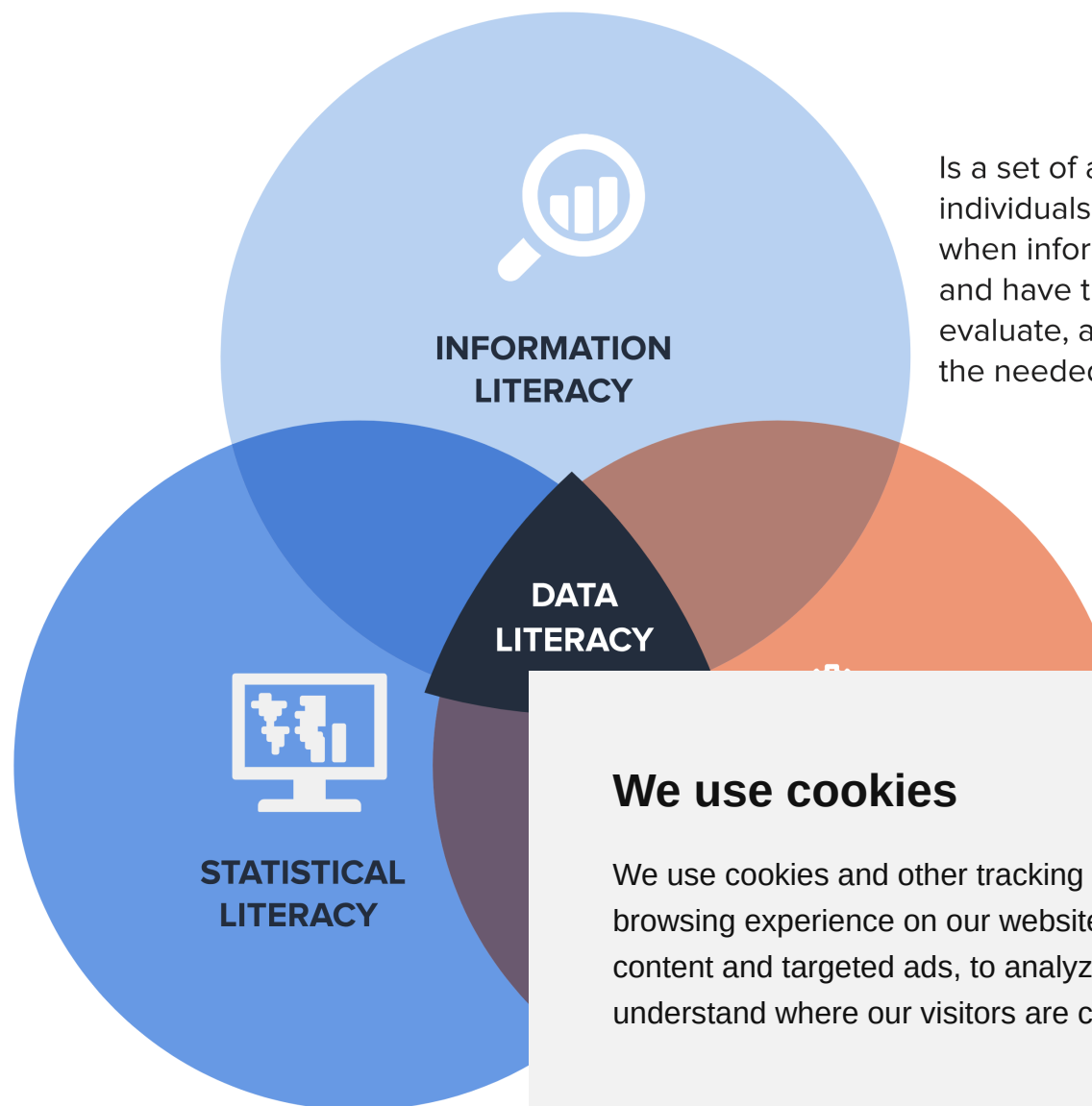
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Data Literacy

Refers to use of statistics as evidence, encompassing what to count or measure, how to assemble those measurements into summary statistics, what comparisons to form from these statistics and how to communicate these statistics.

Source: UN Data Revolution Group



Is a set of abilities requiring individuals to “recognize when information is needed and have the ability to locate, evaluate, and use effectively the needed information.

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Data Skills Framework



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3. Operationalise data capacity building

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Short-term

- Training workshops
- Online training resources
- Knowledge sharing on global innovations and use cases

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Medium-term

- Internal data champions
- Periodic data skills training
- Pilot data projects
- Build complementary skills with other stakeholders
- Build on local knowledge and capacities
- Build network of data practitioners

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Long-term

- Embed data skills in job roles
- Institutionalize data training programs
- Partner with think tanks and external organizations
- Partner with academia and local universities

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